

CityTech TTP Summer Bootcamp

Whiteboard Coding and Continuing Mini Project

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Agenda

1. Review
2. Follow Ups: Inspiration, Planning, Navigating JSON
3. Technical Interviews
4. Whiteboard Coding Exercise
5. Continue the Mini Project

Review

What are the most important things you remember from yesterday?

Follow Up: Mini Project Inspiration

The **Who's That Pokémon?** game you're building is inspired (in part) by **Framed**:

<https://framed.wtf/>

- Framed shows a movie **one frame at a time**; each wrong guess reveals **another frame** (another hint)
- Same core loop as your project: **guess, get a hint, guess again**
- Progressive hints keep it fun: vague at first, easier with each reveal

Follow Up: Plan Before You Code

Starting a new project is hard. Before writing code, take time to **brainstorm, diagram, and outline** your plan.

- Like an **essay outline**, a project outline makes the actual building far smoother
- Sketch your **routes, data, and game flow** before you implement them
- And just **play with the API** first: poke `pokeapi.co` in Insomnia or the browser to see what data comes back

A little planning up front saves a lot of debugging later.

Follow Up: Navigating JSON

The JSON from PokéAPI can be **huge**. Explore it layer by layer instead of reading it all at once. `Object.keys(...)` gives the keys at the current level:

```
console.log(Object.keys(pokemon));  
// ["abilities", "moves", "height", "types", "cries", ...]
```

Then **zoom in** on a key. For arrays, index in and peek at that item's keys:

```
console.log(Object.keys(pokemon.moves[0]));  
// ["move", "version_group_details"]  
  
console.log(Object.keys(pokemon.sprites));  
// ["back_default", "front_default", ..., "other", "versions"]  
  
console.log(Object.keys(pokemon.sprites.other));  
// ["dream_world", "home", "official-artwork", "showdown"]
```

Technical Job Interviews

Many software jobs include a **technical interview**: you solve coding problems and/or answer technical questions live, in front of someone.

- Often **no IDE, no internet, and no AI assistant**: just you and the problem
- They test how you **think and communicate**, not only the final answer

Whiteboard Coding

One common format is **whiteboard coding**: you write code by hand, on a whiteboard or in a plain editor, while explaining yourself.

- **Think out loud** so the interviewer can follow your reasoning
- **Clarify the problem** and ask about edge cases before you start
- **Plan first** (pseudocode or an outline), then write the code
- Don't stress over perfect syntax; aim for a clear, correct approach

Coding Without AI

In most interviews, **AI tools are off-limits**: no Copilot, no ChatGPT, no autocomplete.

- Interviewers don't expect **perfect syntax**: just enough that they can tell what you're doing
- This is why we say: **never submit code you can't explain**
- **AI replaces labor; AI does not replace learning**
- So practice **coding by hand** sometimes, with no AI

Exercise: Whiteboard Coding

A practice run, like the real thing.

- **Papers will be distributed** to write on
- **No laptops, no phones.** In the real world, an interviewer may note that and end the interview early
- You have **20 minutes**

Note: interviewers aren't looking for **perfect, bug-free, or complete** code; they want to see your **approach and reasoning**.

Continue Yesterday's Mini Project

Keep building **Who's That Pokémon?**

- Pick up where you left off on your Express server
- Full spec: `project_specs/whos_that_pokemon.md`